▼ GLASSHOUSE



EL CONGO VS YELLOW NINO

It's getting quite prickly in the shade in the Deccan. With both Andhra Pradesh and Telangana facing an El Nino year and drought conditions in several areas, the ruling parties are facing charges of inaction. Opposition leaders in both states are having a field day coining novel terms to target the incumbents. In Andhra, **Jagan Mohan Reddy** of the YSR Congress remarked that the crisis was "not due to El Nino, but the 'Yellow Nino' effect"—a snide reference to the favoured colour of CM **Chandrababu Naidu's** Telugu Desam Party. Meanwhile, in Telangana, Bharat Rashtra Samithi working president **K.T. Rama Rao** was going full tilt at the **Revanth Reddy**-led Congress regime. Rejecting the government's El Nino explainer for the power crisis, KTR remarked sarcastically, "This is 'El Congo', a creation of the Congress affecting the state."

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ DEPARTING SHOTS

AN EX TO GRIND

Once close allies, **Akhilesh Yadav** and **Om Prakash Rajbhar** are losing no chance to lay into each other as the 2027 Uttar Pradesh election nears. The latest salvos began when the Samajwadi Party (SP) chief said he would consider taking Rajbhar back if he were to come knocking. The Suheldev Bharatiya Samaj Party honcho was quick to take umbrage, saying Akhilesh had already "given the divorce" and he had accepted it. "Now, how can we go back?" he asked. The irony is hard to miss. Rajbhar's party had allied with the BJP in 2017, switched sides to join the SP for the 2022 assembly election, and then returned to the BJP-led NDA before the 2024 Lok Sabha election. The relationship has since turned bitter. Rajbhar has repeatedly attacked Akhilesh over his lifestyle and alleged disconnect with the non-Yadav OBC communities, while the latter has taken digs at his "flighty" nature.

